GK Yaad Rahega

GKYaadRahega

ONE SHOT REVISION

INSCRIPTIONS OF INDIA

UPSC | State PCS | SSC | Banking | Railway | Defence | Police

GK Yaad Rahega

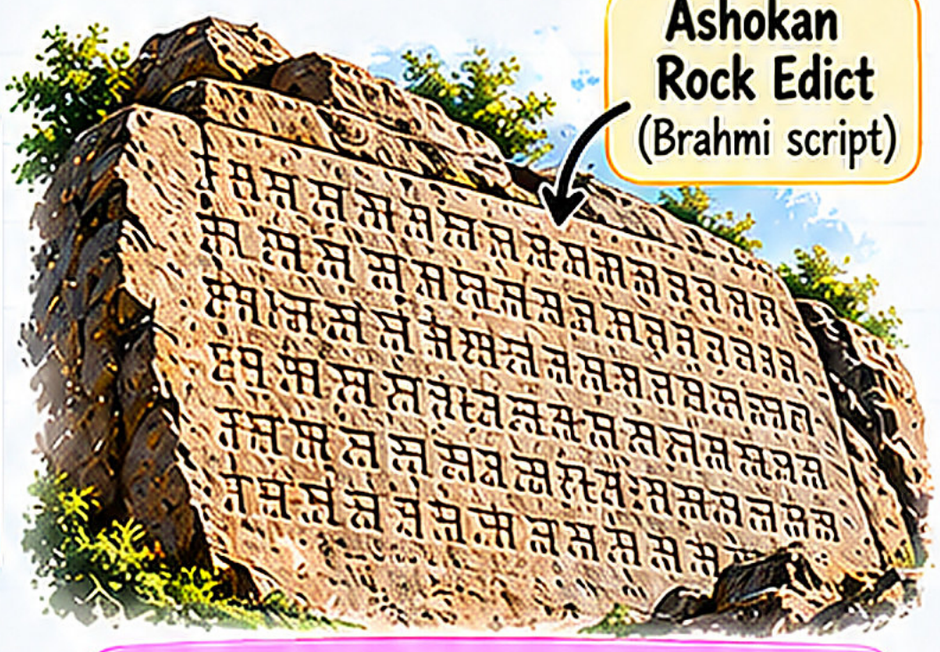
GKYaadRahega
Ancient History Series

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

ASHOKAN MAJOR ROCK EDICTS

ABOUT MAJOR ROCK EDICTS

- Issued by **Emperor Ashoka** (3rd century BCE).
- Total **14** Major Rock Edicts (I–XIV).
- Written in **Prakrit** language.
- In **Brahmi script** (except at Shahbazgarhi & Mansehra, where **Kharosthi script** is used).



KEY THEMES (SELECTED EDICTS)

I — Prohibits **animal slaughter** and encourages moral conduct.

II — Emphasises **medical care** for humans and animals; planting of medicinal plants and digging of wells.

III — Stresses respect for **parents, elders, Brahmanas** and **Shramanas**.

V — Appointment of **Dhamma Mahamatras** to spread Dhamma.

VIII — **Dhamma tours** to propagate moral values (replace royal pleasure tours).

XII — Promotes respect and tolerance among different **religious sects**.

XIII — **Kalinga War**, Ashoka's **remorse** and policy of **conquest by Dhamma**.

XIV — Purpose of the edicts and reasons for their **variation** at different places.

KALINGA WAR (ROCK EDICT XIII)

- Expresses **deep remorse** after the Kalinga War.
- Highlights the **suffering** of people.
- Promotes **Dhamma** instead of military conquests.

SEPARATE KALINGA EDICTS

- Found at **Dhauli** and **Jaugada** (Odisha).
- Replace Major Rock Edicts **XI–XIII** in this region.
- Focus more on instructions to officials and Dhamma.

IMPORTANT SITES

- **Shahbazgarhi** – Kharosthi script (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan).
- **Mansehra** – Kharosthi script (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan).
- **Other major sites** – spread across India, Nepal, Pakistan and Afghanistan.

Useful for: UPSC | State PCS | SSC | Banking | Railway | Defence | Police

GK Yaad Rahega

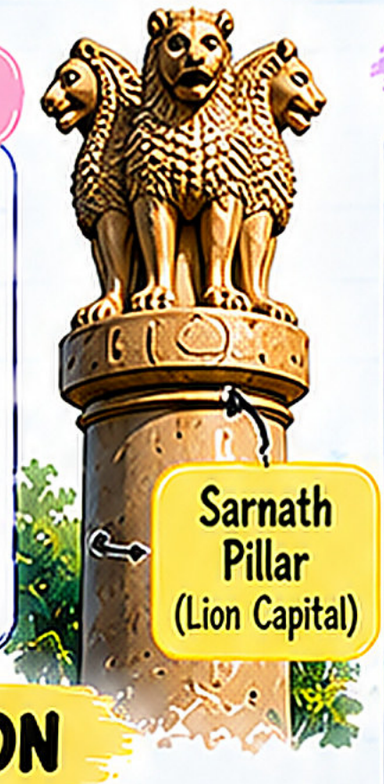
IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

GKYaadRahega
Ancient History Series

ASHOKAN PILLAR AND MINOR INSCRIPTIONS

ASHOKAN PILLAR INSCRIPTIONS

- Mostly written in **Prakrit** language and **Brahmi script**.
- Installed on **monolithic stone pillars**.
- Conveyed messages of **Dhamma**.
- Found at various places across India and neighbouring regions.


Sarnath Pillar (Lion Capital)

IMPORTANT PILLAR EDICTS

- **I** Prohibits **animal sacrifice**.
- **II** Emphasises **moral conduct**.
- **III** Stresses obedience to parents, elders and **respect for all sects**.
- **IV** Promotes **Dhamma** and welfare of people.
- **V** Appointment of **Dhamma Mahamatras**.
- **VI** Concern for all religions and **religious harmony**.
- **VII** Summarises Ashoka's policy of **Dhamma**.

RUMMINDEI (LUMBINI) INSCRIPTION

Lumbini Pillar

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Lumbini (Nepal)**
- Significance: Mentions the **birthplace of Lord Buddha**.
- Script & language: Brahmi, Prakrit

NIGALI SAGAR INSCRIPTION

Nigali Sagar Pillar

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Nigali Sagar (Nepal)**
- Significance: Mentions enlargement of the stupa of **Kanakamuni Buddha**.
- Script & language: Brahmi, Prakrit

MASKI INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Maski (Karnataka)**
- Significance: First inscription to mention the **name 'Ashoka' explicitly.**
- Script & language: Brahmi, Prakrit

Maski Inscription

BAIRAT (BHABRU) EDICT

Bairat Inscription

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Bairat (Rajasthan)**
- Significance: Mentions the **Buddha's teachings** and recommends specific Buddhist texts to the Sangha.
- Script & language: Brahmi, Prakrit

BRAHMAGIRI AND OTHER MINOR ROCK EDICTS

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Locations: **Brahmagiri** (Karnataka), Siddapur, Jatinga-Rameshwar, Gavimath and others.
- Significance: Contain messages of **Dhamma** for local people and officials.
- Script & language: **Brahmi, Prakrit**

Brahmagiri Inscription

GIRNAR PILLAR INSCRIPTION

Girnar Pillar

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Girnar (Gujarat)**
- Significance: Contains one of the major pillar edicts on **Dhamma**.
- Script & language: **Brahmi, Prakrit**

LAURIYA NANDANGARH PILLAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: **Ashoka**
- Location: **Lauria Nandangarh (Bihar)**
- Significance: Contains pillar edicts related to **Dhamma**.
- Script & language: **Brahmi, Prakrit**

Lauria Nandangarh Pillar

GK Yaad Rahega

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

GKYaadRahega
Ancient History Series

EARLY HISTORIC INSCRIPTIONS

1 HATHIGUMPHA INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Kharavela
- Location: Udayagiri Hills (Odisha)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Describes Kharavela's military conquests, public works and patronage of Jainism.

Hathigumpha Inscription

2 HELIODORUS PILLAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated person: Heliodorus (Greek ambassador of King Antialkidas)
- Location: Besnagar (Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions Heliodorus as a devotee of Vasudeva (Krishna); earliest evidence of Bhagavata tradition.

Heliodorus Pillar

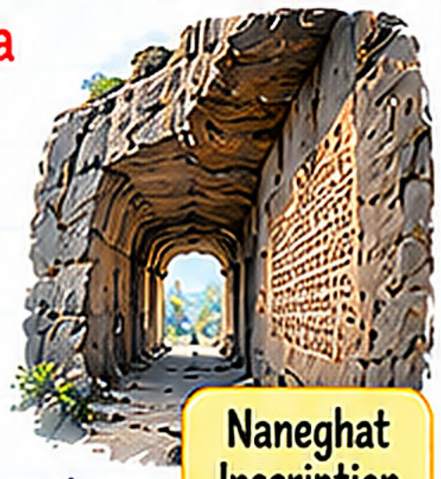
3 SOHGAURA COPPER-PLATE INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Probably Ashoka (Mauryan period)
- Location: Sohgaura (Bihar)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Earliest known inscription related to famine relief and distribution of food grains.

Sohgaura Copper Plate

4 NANEGHAT INSCRIPTION

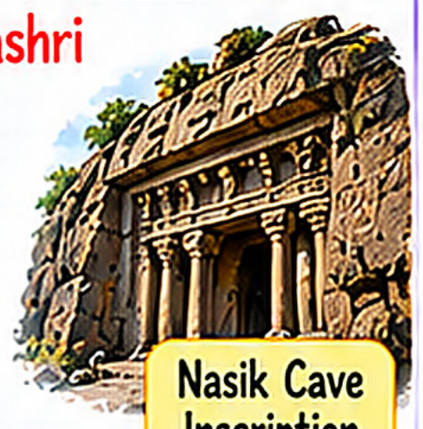
- Associated ruler: Naganika (wife of Satavahana ruler Satakarni I)
- Location: Naneghat (Maharashtra)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions royal genealogy, Ashvamedha sacrifice and donations to Brahmanas.



Naneghat Inscription

5 NASIK CAVE INSCRIPTION

- Associated person: Gautami Balashri (mother of Satavahana ruler Gautamiputra Satakarni)
- Location: Nasik (Maharashtra)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Describes the achievements of Gautamiputra Satakarni and his struggle against Shakas.



Nasik Cave Inscription

6 PIPRAHWA INSCRIPTION

- Associated with: Buddhist relics (stupa of Buddha)
- Location: Piprahwa (Uttar Pradesh)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the relics of the Buddha and the Sakya clan (Shakyanas Bhagini-putanan).

Piprahwa Inscription

GK Yaad Rahega

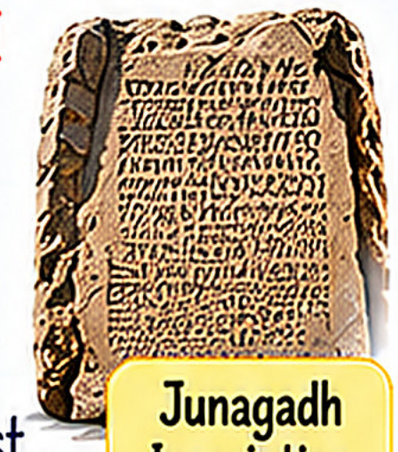
GKYaadRahega
Ancient History Series

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

SHAKA, SATAVAHANA AND KUSHANA RECORDS

1 JUNAGADH INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Rudradaman I (Western Kshatrapa)
- Location: Junagadh (Gujarat)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: One of the earliest Sanskrit inscriptions. Mentions the repair of the Sudarshana Lake.



Junagadh Inscription

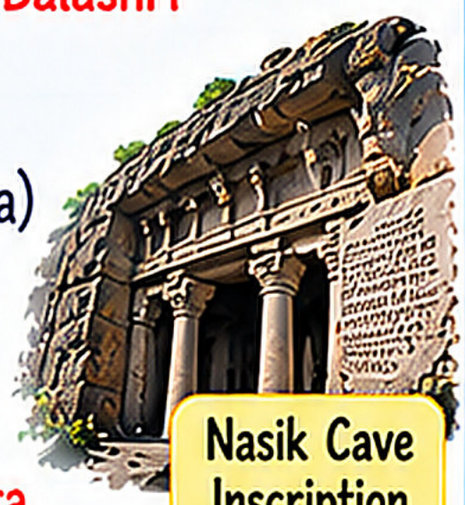
2 NANEGHAT INSCRIPTION

- Associated person: Naganika (wife of Satavahana ruler Satakarni I)
- Location: Naneghat (Maharashtra)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions royal genealogy, performance of Vedic sacrifices and donations.

Naneghat Inscription

3 NASIK CAVE INSCRIPTION

- Associated person: Gautami Balashri (mother of Gautamiputra Satakarni)
- Location: Nasik (Maharashtra)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the achievements of Gautamiputra Satakarni and his struggle against the Shakas.



Nasik Cave Inscription

4 RABATAK INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Kanishka (Kushana)
- Location: Rabatak (Afghanistan)
- Language: Greek and Bactrian
- Script: Greek and Bactrian
- Significance: Mentions Kanishka's titles and his religious policy. Important source for the Kushana kingdom.

Rabatak Inscription

5 MATHURA INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Kanishka
- Location: Mathura (Uttar Pradesh)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the installation of a statute of Kanishka and provides evidence of his rule in India.

Mathura Inscription

6 KARLE INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Probably a Satavahana ruler (donor – Naganika / local rulers)
- Location: Karle (Maharashtra)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions donations for the construction and maintenance of the Karle cave (chaitya).

Karle Inscription

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

GUPTA AND POST-GUPTA INSCRIPTIONS

1 PRAYAGA PRASHASTI INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Samudragupta
- Composer: Harisena
- Location: Prayagraj (Uttar Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Describes Samudragupta's conquests, empire and policy of "dighvijaya".

Prayaga Pillar Inscription

2 MEHRAULI IRON PILLAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: King Chandra (Gupta period)
- Location: Mehrauli (Delhi)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the victories of King Chandra (probably Chandragupta II). Shows high level of iron metallurgy.

Mehrauli Iron Pillar

3 BHITARI PILLAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Skandagupta
- Location: Bhitari (Uttar Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Provides information about Skandagupta's achievements, including his struggle against the Hunas.

Bhitari Pillar Inscription

4 JUNAGADH INSCRIPTION (SKANDAGUPTA)

- Associated ruler: Skandagupta
- Location: Junagadh (Gujarat)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the repair of the Sudarshana Lake after damage caused by a severe flood.

Junagadh Inscription

5 MANDSAUR INSCRIPTIONS

- Associated ruler: Kumaragupta I and later rulers
- Location: Mandsaur (Madhya Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Records by the silk-weavers' guild (Sreshthins) about the construction and renovation of a Sun temple.

Mandsaur Inscription

6 DAMODARPUR COPPER-PLATE INSCRIPTIONS

- Associated ruler: Gupta rulers (Kumaragupta I, Budhagupta, etc.)
- Location: Damodarpur (West Bengal)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Provide valuable information about land grants, administration and rural economy.

Damodarpur Copper Plates

GK Yaad Rahega

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

GKYaadRahega
Ancient History Series

SOUTH INDIAN AND REGIONAL INSCRIPTIONS

1 AILHOLE INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Pulakeshin II
- Composer: Ravikirti
- Location: Aihole (Karnataka)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Early Kannada
- Significance: Describes the achievements of Pulakeshin II and the conflict with Harshavardhana.

Aihole Inscription

2 TALAGUNDA INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Mayurasharma
- Location: Talagunda (Karnataka)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Early Kannada
- Significance: Provides information about the origins and early history of the Kadamba dynasty.

Talagunda Inscription

3 UTTARAMERUR INSCRIPTION

- Associated dynasty: Cholas
- Location: Uttaramerur (Tamil Nadu)
- Language: Tamil
- Script: Tamil
- Significance: Describes the village self-government system with a detailed electoral procedure (Kudavolai system).

Uttaramerur Inscription

4 HALMIDI INSCRIPTION

- Associated period: Early Chalukya period (6th century CE)
- Location: Halmidi (Karnataka)
- Language: Kannada
- Script: Early Kannada
- Significance: Considered the earliest known inscription in Kannada language.

Halmidi Inscription

5 VELVIKUDI COPPER PLATE

- Associated dynasty: Pandya
- Location: Velvikudi (Tamil Nadu)
- Language: Sanskrit and Tamil
- Script: Grantha and Tamil
- Significance: Records the regrant of a village to Brahmins and provides information about the Pandya dynasty and land grants.

Velvikudi Copper Plate

6 LEIDEN COPPER PLATE

- Associated dynasty: Pallava
- Location: Leiden (originally from Andhra Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Grantha
- Significance: Contains a royal genealogy of the Pallava rulers and mentions their donations and conquests.

Leiden Copper Plate

IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS IN INDIAN HISTORY

MISCELLANEOUS IMPORTANT INSCRIPTIONS

1 BESNAGAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated person: Heliodorus (Greek ambassador of King Antialkidas)
- Location: Besnagar (Madhya Pradesh)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions Heliodorus as a devotee of Vasudeva (Krishna) and is an important source for Indo-Greek relations.

Besnagar Inscription

2 HATHIBADA INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Kharavela
- Location: Hathibada (Odisha)
- Language: Prakrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Similar to Hathigumpha, it also describes the achievements of Kharavela and his military conquests.

Hathibada Inscription

3 GIRNAR INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Rupadaman I
- Location: Girnar (Gujarat)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the repair of the Sudarshana Lake (after damage by flood) and provides information about the Western Kshatrapas.

Girnar Inscription

4 ERAN INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Gupta rulers (especially Budhagupta)
- Location: Eran (Madhya Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions the construction of a Vishnu temple and provides evidence of the Guptas' religious policy and art.

Eran Inscription

5 BILSAD INSCRIPTION

- Associated ruler: Chandragupta II
- Location: Bilsad (Uttar Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Gupta Brahmi
- Significance: Mentions grants to Brahmins and provides information about the administration and territorial extent of the Gupta Empire.

Bilsad Inscription

6 NAGARI INSCRIPTION

- Associated dynasty: Early Chalukyas
- Location: Nagari (Andhra Pradesh)
- Language: Sanskrit
- Script: Early Telugu-Kannada
- Significance: Provides information about the Early Chalukyas, their rule and the development of regional administration in the Deccan.

Nagari Inscription

GK Yaad Rahega

GKYaadRahega

Quality Notes for Serious Learners

Complete Subject-Wise Notes at Affordable Prices !

ALL 12 SUBJECTS NOTES SERIES

Complete • Exam-Focused • Easy Revision

1. HISTORY

- Ancient History
- Medieval History
- Modern History

₹119/-

2. ART & CULTURE

- Indian Art & Culture
- Dance, Music
- Architecture
- Literature

₹49/-

3. GEOGRAPHY

- Indian Geography
- World Geography
- Physical Geography

₹109/-

4. POLITY

- Constitution
- Governance
- Parliament
- Judiciary

₹99/-

5. ECONOMICS

- Basic Concepts
- Indian Economy
- Banking
- Budget

₹99/-

6. GENERAL SCIENCE

- Physics
- Chemistry
- Biology

₹99/-

7. ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

- Ecology
- Biodiversity
- Environment
- Climate Change

₹79/-

8. COMPUTER

- Fundamentals
- Applications
- Internet & Networking

₹79/-

9. STATIC GK

- Awards
- Sports
- Books
- Important Days
- Miscellaneous GK

₹99/-

10. SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

- Space
- Defence
- Emerging Technologies
- Major Missions

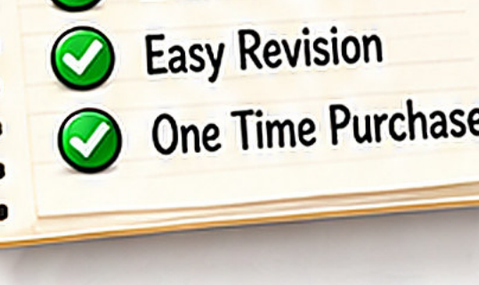
₹79/-

11. CURRENT AFFAIRS

- National & International
- Important Schemes
- Important Developments

₹49/-

12. ENGLISH



- Grammar
- Basics

₹49/-

COMPLETE NOTES BUNDLE

All 12 Subjects

Complete • Exam-Focused
Easy Revision • One Time Purchase

~~₹1008/-~~

NOW ONLY

₹499/-

- 12 Subject PDFs
- Complete Notes
- Exam-Focused
- Easy Revision
- One Time Purchase

GK Yaad Rahega

GKYaadRahega

Quality Notes for Serious Learners

COMBO PACKS

Best Combo Offers for Smarter Preparation !

History
Geography
Polity
Economics

Complete • Exam-Focused • High-Quality Notes

COMBO 1 (5 SUBJECTS)

Complete & Exam-Focused Notes of 5 Important Subjects

HISTORY	GEOGRAPHY	ECONOMICS	POLITY	ART & CULTURE
Complete Notes	Complete Notes	Complete Notes	Complete Notes	Complete Notes

Only ₹249/-

✓ Complete Notes ✓ Exam-Focused ✓ Easy Revision ✓ Well-Structured

COMBO 2 (4 SUBJECTS)

Complete & Exam-Focused Notes of 4 Important Subjects

GENERAL SCIENCE	SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY	ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY	COMPUTER
Complete Notes	Complete Notes	Complete Notes	Complete Notes

Only ₹249/-

✓ Complete Notes ✓ Exam-Focused ✓ Easy Revision ✓ Well-Structured

COMBO 3 (ALL 12 SUBJECTS + PYQs)

BEST VALUE

Complete Notes of All 12 Subjects + PYQs of 4 Major Subjects

- ✓ Complete Notes (12 Subjects)
- ✓ PYQs (History, Geography, Economics & Polity)
- ✓ Exam-Focused
- ✓ Easy Revision
- ✓ Well-Structured
- ✓ One Time Purchase

History · Art & Culture · Geography · Polity · Economics · General Science · Environment · Computer · Static GK · Sci & Tech · Current Affairs · English

+ PYQs (4 Subjects): History PYQs · Geography PYQs · Economics PYQs · Polity PYQs

Only ₹599/-